

Name: _____

Date: _____

Why Do Owls Hunt at Night?

Year 3 reading comprehension · Information text · 11 marks · About 15 minutes

Night hunters

Most owls hunt in the dark. They sleep for much of the day, often hidden in a tree or a barn, and wake up when the sun goes down. Animals that are awake at night are called nocturnal.

Big eyes

An owl has very large eyes, which let in as much light as possible. This helps it to see in the dark. But an owl cannot move its eyes in their sockets. Instead, it turns its whole head. An owl can turn its head about three-quarters of the way round to look behind it!

Sharp ears

Owls also have amazing hearing. Their ears are hidden under the feathers on the sides of their heads. An owl can hear a tiny mouse rustling in the grass from far away.

Silent wings

Most birds make a flapping noise when they fly, but owls fly almost silently. Their wing feathers are soft and have fringed edges, so the air slips past quietly. A mouse cannot hear the owl coming.

1. What word means “awake at night”? (1 mark)

2. Why does an owl have very large eyes? (1 mark)

3. Where are an owl’s ears? (1 mark)

4. Find and copy one word from the “Sharp ears” section that means “wonderful”. (1 mark)

5. Why does an owl turn its whole head to look around? (1 mark)

6. How do soft feathers help an owl to hunt? (2 marks)

7. Why do you think owls sleep in hidden places during the day? (2 marks)

8. Write one sentence to explain how an owl's body helps it to hunt in the dark. (2 marks)

Writing task: Imagine you are an owl at night. Write five sentences about what you see, hear and do.
